



DEALER BEST PRACTICE SERIES

Hydraulic Press Protection Cage

Application Maintenance Site Management **Component Rebuild** Component Life Management Safety MARC Management

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1.0 Introduction

Hydraulic presses use multiple tons of force to remove/install pins, bushings, and other press-fit parts. This force can cause the part to suddenly give way or fracture, creating a potential risk of flying debris.

Some dealers have designed and built a simple chain link cage around hydraulic presses to protect the operator and other shop personnel from this risk.

This Best Practice is a Quick Win project.

2.0 Best Practice Description

The protective cage (see photos) shown in this Best Practice was designed and fabricated by the dealer. The key features are:

- It is portable and has channels in the base to accommodate transport using a forklift.
- The cage is painted high visibility yellow.
- The back of the cage opens like a gate to allow access to the press and the set up of carriers and other parts on the press. Specific cage dimensions will vary with the press in use, but should allow ample room for operators to move about the press.
- The top of the cage is open to allow access by overhead or jib crane.
- The press is operated by a pigtail remote control while the operator stands outside the cage.
- The cage has a view port so the operator can see the press and hydraulic pump gages.

3.0 Implementation Steps



Cage has open top, gated back, and forklift channels.

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View Port so operator can see gauges.



Pigtail remote control.



4.0 Benefits

Protects operator and other shop personnel from potential flying debris.

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5.0 Resources Required

- The cage requires 8–10 hours to fabricate
- Material cost is under \$1000.

6.0 Supporting Attachments / References

None.

7.0 Related Best Practices

None.

8.0 Acknowledgements

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